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Youth and Terrorism

Introduction

Taliban are terrorists. Politically motivated; scare and harm; want to impose an ideology.

It brings up the argument of security versus freedom. How much of our freedom are we willing to give up for that security.

In one of my local mosques Mumtaz Qadri (Salman Taseer's killer) is called Amin. It is a Barelvi mosque. In another Deobandi mosque they were praying for Bin Laden. This was happening in Karachi. These people are not even genuine aalim, but they are heading these mosques.

(Focus Group, Private University[1])

Pakistan has been transformed by terrorism. Passing through urban centres of Pakistan today, a common sight that one encounters is the presence of checkpoints; barbed wire fences around public institutions, especially government offices that have raised their boundary walls; educational institutions that have increased their security – in essence urban centres that have visually become securitized as a consequence of the constant threat of terror confronting these cities. Of course, such security measures are more evident in the rich neighbourhoods of cities such as Lahore, Karachi, Islamabad or Peshawar, since the level of both security and insecurity varies across neighbourhoods and different parts of Pakistan, and not every part of a city is considered equally at risk, or the people there equally worthy of protection. While certain parts of the country such as FATA, Provincially Administered Tribal Areas (PATA), Waziristan and certain areas in KP have at different points been at the frontline in the war against terrorism, this threat is nonetheless pervasive, evident in attacks on minority communities in urban cities, Sufi shrines, hotels, schools and universities as well